

Accelerate

Summer 2012

The quarterly newsletter for the Conference Of Minority Transportation Officials

A Discussion with Robert H. Prince, Jr. COMTO National Chair



In the long and distinguished history of COMTO, few people have been as well prepared to step into the chairmanship of the organization as is **Robert H. Prince, Jr.** A long-standing member of the COMTO board, nationally known and admired industry leader, and an executive with leadership experience on many other transportation related boards, Bob brings a powerhouse professional resume and a staggering history of industry experience to bear as he takes the COMTO reins.

Currently Vice President, Transit Business Development Director for AECOM, a position he assumed following a distinguished 25-year career with the Massachusetts Bay Transportation Authority, Bob deals with national transit issues with a focus on the state of good repair/capital needs assessments, security analyses, bus rapid transit development, operations and maintenance planning, and new system start-ups.

His experience encompasses transit system operations, transit project management and transit agency management. He has extensive experience in planning and implementing safety and security programs for transit properties, including transit police training, transit operations training and implementation of advanced technology.

But it is his exceptional compassion for people and for establishing a level playing field in the transportation field that have distinguished Bob Prince across this industry. *Accelerate* had an opportunity recently to catch up with Bob and to gather some reflections, some insights and some plans for the future.

Accelerate: What changes have you seen regarding minority participation since you first started working in the transportation industry?

Prince: In the past 36 years I have witnessed many changes for minorities and women in transportation. Most importantly, I have seen increased visibility in key decision making roles, roles that include the general managers in many instances. I also think there's a better understanding that transportation presents real opportunities for careers for minorities, not just for jobs.

Accelerate: What role, if any, did COMTO play in furthering your career?

Prince: My affiliation with COMTO taught me to look "outside the box." I learned to communicate more freely with my peers and with top-level officials. I learned that I was not alone and that there was excellent information and advice available to me in the COMTO community and that it was there for the asking. COMTO became my "kitchen cabinet," my "go to" resource for navigating within the complex transportation industry.

Accelerate: What are the most pressing issues facing COMTO today?

Prince: Well, certainly we need to continue the charge for a level playing field. Our work in support of Historically Underutilized Businesses (HUBs) is vital in this effort. And our scholarship, internship and mentoring programs are key to introducing talented minority youth into this industry, which is another issue at the top of our list. In addition, it's critical that COMTO continues to expand its programs and services to reflect the expanding nature of our multimodal membership.

Accelerate: What role will local chapters play in the organization as COMTO moves forward?

Prince: We will never lose sight of the fact that it all begins at the grassroots. Our flourishing web of local chapters sets the pace in everything from advocacy and membership recruitment to scholarships and career development. At the national level, we are vigilant in our support of these vital local efforts.

Accelerate: How do you think COMTO is positioned to help HUBs?

Prince: During the past few years COMTO has spent a lot of energy developing and nurturing relationships with state departments of transportation, with transit properties and with legislators. We have earned a level of respect from these stakeholders that very few other organizations can claim. We've also earned a "seat at the table" where our voice is heard and considered. Hundreds of HUBs across the nation – especially HUBs who are COMTO members – reap the benefits of these relationships. This is one of the more recent COMTO efforts of which I am most proud.

Accelerate: What message does COMTO need to convey to national and state legislators to ensure more inclusivity?

Prince: It's a message that we've already been trumpeting for quite some time: COMTO is here to stay and we're a force to be reckoned with! Our organization, and the members we represent, are part of the fabric that makes up this nation. We demand a level playing field. And it's no longer enough to allow us to buy tickets to the ballpark... we must be playing in the game!

Accelerate: What do you hope to see COMTO accomplish under your leadership?

Prince: It's pretty fundamental, just one word will describe it all: GROWTH. I want to see our membership grow, I want to see our members' position in the industry grow, I want to see the prestige of the organization grow and I want to see our financial position grow. That's not to say that growth in and of itself is always best. But I am a firm believer that as COMTO grows, we are better able to develop and support efforts to improve the lives and careers of our members. And that's something I know we can all get behind. ■

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INVESTING IN THE **WORKFORCE** REBUILDING THE **NATION**

COMTO Celebrates 41 Years of Legacy with Successful National Meeting

COMTO's 41st Annual Meeting and Training Conference was held July 21-25 at the Embassy Suites in Denver, Colorado. Denver Transit Partner (DTP) and COMTO Colorado State served as our hosts.

U.S. Department of Transportation Officials who participated in the conference included the following Administrators:

Peter Rogoff, Federal Transit Administration;

David Strickland, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration; **Gregory D. Winfree**, Research, Innovation and Technology Administration (RITA); and the Honorable

Gregory Lopez, US Small Business Administration, Colorado District Director. Other noted speakers joining at the conference were renowned speakers **Dr. DeForest Soaries** of the First Baptist Church of Lincoln Gardens, Somerset, NJ and **George C. Fraser**, FraserNet, Cleveland Heights, OH.

A special thanks to COMTO Colorado for their work with COMTO National to ensure a successful conference.



**We hope to see you
July 13-17, 2013 in
Jacksonville, Florida for the
42nd National Meeting and
Training Conference, hosted
by COMTO Jacksonville.**

COMTO wishes to thank this year's sponsors and exhibitors for their support. COMTO recognizes the partnership and support each of these vendors brings to us not only during the conference but throughout the year.

Premier Legacy Partner AECOM

Premier Partner Denver Transit Partners (DTP)

Chairman's Circle Level Kiewit Colorado LTK Engineering Services Parsons Brinckerhoff

Diamond Level CH2M HILL MV Transportation, Inc. Regional Transportation District (RTD)

Platinum Level Cubic Transportation Systems Denver Transit Construction Group (DTCG) WMATA

Silver Level Alstom Transportation, Inc. Atkins North America First Transit Herzog Transit Services, Inc. Jacobs Engineering Group, Inc. Maryland Transportation Authority STV

Bronze Level American Public Transportation Association (APTA) Briggs Field Services Dallas Rapid Transit (DART) G.W. People's Contracting Co., Inc. Maruti Transit Group McKissack & McKissack Michael Baker Company RTA Chicago South Florida Regional Transportation Authority Transportation America USSC Group Veolia Transportation

Friends of COMTO Amtrak Bank of America Merrill Lynch Briggs Field Services GFI Genefare IBI Group Keolis Transit America Miami International Airport

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RouteMatch Software
Swayzer Engineering, Inc.
Townsend Management, LLC
Triunity Engineering & Management, Inc.
Xerox

Transportation Partners

Amtrak
Avis
Hertz
United Airlines

Agency Hosts

Regional Transportation District (RTD)
Denver International Airport (DIA)

Chapter Host

COMTO Colorado Chapter

Exhibitors

Acumen Building Enterprise, Inc.
AECOM
American Public Transportation Association (APTA)
Apollo Video Technology
Atkins North America
Briggs Field services
CH2M HILL
Denver Transit Construction Group
Denver Transit Partners
Federal Highway Administration (FTA)
First Transit
G.W. People's Contracting Co., Inc.
Herzog Transit Services, Inc.
McKissack & McKissack
Michael Baker Company
Motor Coach Industries, Inc.
Parsons Brinckerhoff
Q'Straint/Sure-Lok
RTA Chicago
Seon Design, Inc./Seon Systems Sales, Inc.
The Transit Cooperative Research Program (TCRP)
Transit Marketing Group
Transportation Leadership Grad Certificate
Transportation Research Board (TRB)
USSC Group

COMTO National

COMTO Members Witness White House Signing

COMTO had the esteemed honor of being invited to the White House on Friday, July 6, 2012, to witness the signing of MAP-21 by President Obama. **Dr. Kendra Taylor**, COMTO Membership Chair (CH2M HILL); **Greer Gillis**, Chair of Women Who Move Nation (Parsons Brinckerhoff); **Freddie Fuller**, Strategic Planning Chair (CUBIC), and I, **Robert H. Prince, Jr.** your National Chair (AECOM), were pleased to represent our membership.

As I reflected on the event, I felt tremendous pride that COMTO was invited among the "who's who" of Congress, labor, state and local governments, and other advocacy organizations. Seated only a few feet from the President's podium, our leadership sat in close proximity with FTA Administrator **Peter Rogoff** and FHWA Administrator **Victor Mendes**.

My COMTO colleagues and I were honored, to say the least. Those in attendance represented the true spirit of the public and private sectors. I can't help but believe we all reflected on and appreciated the number of jobs saved and those to be created as our nation moves to rebuild its infrastructure.



COMTO representatives were present during President Obama's signing of MAP-21

Last, but not least for COMTO, we also know that our influence to help ensure a place at the table for our Historically Underutilized Businesses is greater now than ever before. The signing of the bill is a catalyst to ensure they are also represented on transportation projects. I am grateful for having had the opportunity to witness this historic event and proud to be a COMTO member.

Respectfully,

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Robert H. Prince".

Robert H. Prince, Jr.
Chair, COMTO and Vice President, AECOM

2012-2014 COMTO Board of Directors

COMTO is excited to announce the 2012-2014 Board of Directors! Congratulations to all those elected.

MEET YOUR NEW LEADERS:

National Chair



Robert H. Prince, Jr.
Transit Business Development Director
Vice President
AECOM
Boston, MA

1st Vice Chair



Warren Montague
Director, Service Operations
Southeastern Pennsylvania Transportation Authority (SEPTA)
Philadelphia, PA

2nd Vice Chair



Lester Woods, Jr.
External Civil Rights Director
Missouri Department of Transportation (MODOT)
Jefferson City, MO

Secretary/Treasurer



Frank T. Martin
Senior Vice President
Atkins North America
Tallahassee, FL

Immediate Past Chair



Roosevelt Bradley
President and CEO
United Brake & Clutch Service, LLC
Medley, FL

At-Large Members



Mary Ann Collier
Director of Operations
Swayzer Engineering, Inc.
Dallas, TX



Freddie Fuller, II
Regional Sales Manager
Cubic Transportation Systems, Inc.
Arlington, VA



John M. Lewis
Chief Executive Officer
Central Florida Regional Transportation Authority
Orlando, FL



Dianne T. Mendoza, PhD
DBE Officer/Director of Equal Employment & Business Opportunity Programs
VIA Metropolitan Transit
San Antonio, TX



Adiele Nwankwo, PhD
Senior Vice President
Parsons Brinckerhoff Americas, Inc.
Detroit, MI

Council of Presidents Representatives



Renee Edwards-Current
Technical Services Administrator
Dallas Area Rapid Transit
Dallas, TX



Emille Williams
Manager of Engineering
Southeastern Pennsylvania Transportation Authority
Philadelphia, PA



Joseph Erves (Alternate)
Director of Rail Car Maintenance
Metropolitan Atlanta Rapid Transit Authority
Atlanta, GA

HATS OFF TO COMTO COLORADO!

On behalf of the COMTO leadership, national staff, members and guests, we express a heartfelt **Thank You to the Colorado Chapter** for having been such an accommodating, friendly and diligent host chapter, and for providing members nationwide with such an exceptional conference experience. We recognize the leadership of Local Conference Chair **Lloyd Lovell** and Local Conference Administrator **Maxine Pryor** along with each member of the Host Chapter Planning Committee:

Chapter President (2010-2012)
Walter Bembry

Budget (Revenue/Expenditures)
Maria Christian

Education/Workshops
Dan Pearsall

Events
Marion Combs

Exhibitors/Sponsors
LaChelle Coffey

Fundraising
Chris Martinez

Garrett A. Morgan
Youth Symposium
Colean Bembry

Historically Underutilized
Businesses Connection
Ty Perry

Marketing/Communication
Karen Morales/Liz Viscardi

National Scholars Program
Dr. Mary Davis

Planning
Dan Pearsall

Transportation
Martha Bembry

Volunteer Coordination
Bryant Hill

COMTO National

2012 TCRP AMBASSADORS

TCRP AMBASSADOR: Roscoe Brown



Roscoe Brown is no stranger to conferences, having attended more than his fair share over the years. He chuckles over an attempt to quantify just how many that is. Today, Brown views these professional conferences from a totally new point of view – as an Ambassador for the Transit Cooperative Research Program (TCRP).

Brown is Director of Coordinated Transportation Programs for the Indianapolis Public Transportation Corporation (aka IndyGo). He is also one of 18 TCRP Ambassadors.

"Being an Ambassador has provided me with another perspective," said Brown, describing a recent conference in Baltimore, MD that he's attended many times over the years. Instead of gathering information, he found himself standing on the opposite side of the table, engaged as a provider of information to his peers, industry leaders and end users. "It definitely has a different feel," he said with a laugh. Ambassadors provide information but they also bring information back to the program. They serve TCRP as a primary source of information on research efforts being conducted out in the field at transit properties, as well as the successes, failures and challenges of implementing TCRP and other transit research.

Brown has more than 20 years of experience and involvement in community and public transportation in the City of Indianapolis.

"This is a great opportunity, as a user of TCRP products, to be able to share with my peers in the industry," said Brown, adding that it also keeps him in the forefront of the latest research.



Standing left to right: Stephen Anderson, David White, Emille Williams and (seated left to right): Emeritus Ambassadors: Rene Edwards, Tonya Saxon

Indianapolis is the 13th largest city in the country with a "good system." Yet, like a number of areas that are spread out geographically, it is "woefully under resourced" and, therefore, benefits from research such as TCRP provides, he added.

Brown wanted to be an Ambassador to expand his knowledge in the areas of transit operations and service delivery, particularly regarding the ADA and transportation for the elderly and individuals with disabilities. "I am so impressed with a number of things I've seen in my travels as an Ambassador. It certainly is living up to my expectations."

TCRP research products, such as its reports, syntheses and legal research digests, are available online as well as in hard copy. They are FREE. Search and download at <http://www.tcrponline.org/>. ■

Conference Drawing Winners

Congratulations to the Winners of our Exhibit Hall Game!

This year COMTO attendees received a letter as they visited each exhibitor. The letters spelled out the answer to a puzzle. COMTO held a drawing from the correct entries and provided prizes. This year's answer was **COMTO Investing In The Workforce!**

Jeri Morton – One Year Free COMTO Membership
Southeastern Pennsylvania Transportation Authority (SEPTA)
COMTO Philadelphia Member

Carla Williams – One Free 2013 National Meeting and
Training Conference Registration
Hillsborough Area Regional Transit Authority
Central Florida Chapter Member

Ken Jones – Amazon Kindle
Miami Dade Transit
Miami Chapter Member



Dear Members:

If you have any changes to your contact information, please be sure to update your profile online at www.comto.org — Thank you!

COMTO National

2012 COMTO SCHOLARSHIPS

Congratulations to the 2012 COMTO Scholarship Recipients!

COMTO would like to extend sincere congratulations to the 2012 Scholarship Recipients! The hard work and dedication of these students is unfailingly remarkable, and COMTO is delighted to be able to support them in their educational endeavors.

Partner Scholarships:

Atkins North America Achievement Scholarship – \$2,000
Erin Coombs (Pittsburgh, PA)
University of Pittsburgh – Political Science, History and Urban Studies

Atkins North America Achievement Scholarship – \$2,000
Gregory Jordan-Detamore (Providence, RI)
Brown University – Urban Studies, Geology

Eno Foundation/Robert Prince, Jr. Scholarship – \$3,300
Barney McCoy (Plantation, FL)
Broward County Transit Division

LTK Engineering Scholarship – \$6,000
Renaud Agustin (Miami, FL)
Florida International University – Masters in Engineering Management

Parsons Brinckerhoff Engineering Scholarship – \$2,500
Michael Bastanipour (Urbana, IL)
University of Illinois – Aerospace Engineering

Parsons Brinckerhoff Engineering Scholarship – \$2,500
Mariah Stanley (Washington, DC)
Trinity Washington University – Communications

Parsons Brinckerhoff Golden Apple Scholarship – \$2,500
Chelsey Brown (Charlotte, NC)
Zebulon B. Vance High School – Senior

COMTO National Scholarships:

Thomas G. Neusom Scholarship – \$5,500
Giacomo Cernjul (Atlanta, GA)
Georgia Institute of Technology – Masters in Transportation Systems Engineering

Rosa L. Parks Scholarship – \$4,500
Samson Shivers (McPherson, KS)
McPherson College – Education, Computer Engineering

Carmen E. Turner Scholarship – \$3,500
David Harris (Washington, DC)
Howard University – Computer Science

North Carolina A&T Matching Scholarship – \$3,000
Steven Harris (Greensboro, NC)
North Carolina A&T State University – Supply Chain Management

Trailblazer Scholarship – \$2,500
Betsy Modayil (Philadelphia, PA)
University of Pennsylvania – Finance/Accounting

COMTO Frank T. Martin Scholarship – \$2,500
Sydney Phillips (Washington, DC)
Howard University – English, African American Studies

2012 INDUSTRY AWARDS

Congratulations to Our 2012 Industry Awards Winners!

The commitment and dedication of these individuals, organizations, and of course, our local chapters deserve all of the recognition and gratitude that COMTO can offer. Awards were presented during the 41st Annual Meeting and Training Conference during the Industry Awards Dinner

Chapter Awards



Best Grassroots Activities Award
COMTO San Antonio



Best Membership Recruitment Award | COMTO Philadelphia

Chapter of the Year Award
COMTO Philadelphia

Member Awards



Executive of the Year Award
Mark Gale
Philadelphia
International Airport



Gerald Anderson Sibling Award
Yolanda Romero
Southeastern Pennsylvania
Transportation Authority



Reverend Jerry Moore President's Leadership Award
Renee Edwards-Current
Dallas Area Rapid Transit



Thomas G. Neusom Founders Award
Paul Toliver
New Age Industries, Inc.



COMTO National Board's Exemplary Service Award
Richard Newell
Annapolis Department
of Transportation



Corporate Citizen of the Year Award
Kiewit Colorado



Industry Innovation and Leadership Award
Maryland Transit Administration



Inter-Modal Innovation Award
Maryland Transportation Authority



INVESTING IN THE
WORKFORCE
REBUILDING
THE **NATION**



**COMTO 41st
NATIONAL MEETING AND
TRAINING CONFERENCE**

**JULY 21 – 25, 2012
DENVER, COLORADO**



COMTO LAUNCHES 1ST HUB DAY

Access to Opportunities Through Awareness and Networking

Washington, D.C. (August 2012) – COMTO launched its first Historically Underutilized Business (HUB) Day on July 25, 2012 as part of the 41st National Meeting and Training Conference held in Denver, Colorado. The HUB Day was planned by COMTO's HUB Advisory Council and a group of Denver based volunteers, which included the host chapter conference chair and co-chair and local HUBs/small businesses.

HUB Day was attended by more than 60 people/businesses who heard **George Fraser** of FraserNet, a national speaker and author of several books on the national best seller list.

Additionally, HUBs heard about best practices for partnering with prime consultants, increasing capacity and doing business with entities both in the Denver metropolitan area and nationally. ■



COMTO Welcomes Our New Members

Corporate Members

Denver Transit Partners (DTP)

Historically Underutilized Business (HUB) Members

Intellectual Concepts, LLC
Omni Consulting Group
Ricks Group, LLC
Solaray Engineering, Inc.
The Sanford Group, LLC

Transportation Agencies

VIA Metropolitan Transit

Non-Profits

Associated General Contractors of St. Louis

INDIVIDUALS

Listed by Chapter

At Large

Julian Emerson
Joe Garcia
Harper Hill
Robert Smith

Arizona

Robert Gonzales

Atlanta

Sonjia Adams
Jermaine Charleston
Georgetta Gregory
Cedric McKitt
Monty Montgomery

Austin

Rudy Vera Anderson
Courtney Colter
Dee Porter

Birmingham

Robert Ballard
Debra Burse
Peter Behrman
Michael Bell

Boston

Booker Crawford
Heather Hamilton
Elizabeth McDonnell

Central Florida

Martine Fils-Aime
Kay Jefferson

Chicago

Eunice Escobar
Gustavo Giraldo
Martin Menninger
Salvador Montes
Karen Tolliver

Cleveland

Eddine Dalton
Marsha Pettus
Bernard Pettus

Colorado State

Alicia Avila
Heather Barry
Roger Bartlett
Kathy Berumen
Laurina Daniel

Kim Day

Mary Floyd

Ken Greene

Armonde Hainesworth

Sherman Hamilton

Kenn Hardin

Lee Johnson

Charles Maldonado

Alvin McBorrough

Ronell McNeal

LaQuisha Murray

Carla Perez

Ty Perry

Naquetta Ricks

Miriam Smith

Robert Smith

Liz Viscardi

Stanley Webb

Edwin Williams, Jr.

Diana Woodson

Dallas

Isolina Byrd
Tammy Barrow
Gabriel Beltran
Carlton Billings
Dottie Cheatham
Louis Frisbie
Gerard Grigsby
Nevin Grinnell
Kenneth Hughes
Joanna Manning
Marcus Moore
Don O'Bannon
Voranique Simon
Karen Stagner

Delaware

Beverly Barr-Ford
Lerrissa Boardley
Corey Burris
Renaldo Epps
Dianna Farrell
Taj McNair
Maryann Potts-Lewis
Catherine Smith
Tomika Steele

Ft. Lauderdale

James DeVaughn
Marcin Gadek
Victor Garcia
Deanna Gray
Dale Holness
Kristin Jacobs
Michael Kanefsky
Vivian Kelly
Teresa Moore
Natalie Pustizzi
Wayne Ramnarine Yesbeck

Houston

Peggy Adolph
Vera Bumpers
Harriet Crayton
Justin B. Jackson
Yvette Ladson
Da Li
Tolor Pentecost
Jamaal Schoby
John Wiggins

Indiana

Cecelia Whitfield

Jacksonville

Rod Halloway

Kansas City

Chris Caron
Charles Dilliehunt
Deb Dillner
Robyn Dudney
Debra Hepp
Greg Lever

Maryland

Ravi Amin
Yolanda Cason
Angela Estes
Sheila Finlayson
Eleni Flannery
Pamela Goins-Watts
Pretam Harry
Gary Hinton
Elaine Jones
Veronica McBeth
Levern McElveen
James Means
Ronald Mears
Darrell Mobley
Robert Watkins
Yolanda Weeden

Miami

Renaud Augustin
LaKeisha Brown
Cynthia Burroughs

Michigan

Olukayode Adefeso
Regine Beauboeuf
Leonard Becker
Emmanuel Calzada
Ashley Hufnagel
Rey Obiora
Gnanadesikan Ramanujam

New Jersey

Pamela Ambritz
Keith Daniels
Anita Green

New York

Howard Blyge
Jeffrey Broderick
Yonette Chung
Beverly Fagan
Al Florant
Joseph Harmon
Chenece Lacey
Brenthom McCalmon
Nimat Semmi
Norma Thompson
Diana Tucker
Edward Walker
Richard Watson
Raquel Williams

North Carolina

Franklin Stowe
Andre Thomas

Northern California

Jose Abad
Summer Clark
Margurite Fuller
Denisse Gonzalez
Reginald James
Lavon Jones
Chelsey Kamson
Leah LaCroix
Kate Miller
Anthony Pegram
Anna Ponting
Ramon Solis
Shari Tavafrashti
Cameron Williams
Joel Young

Oregon/SW Washington

Emely Dela Rosa
Monika Johnson
Jonathan Tillman
Paul Toliver

Philadelphia

Estelle Allie
Charles Bailey
Mylene Bard
Bruce Cooper
Agiull Davis
Joyrie Dickerson
Kim Epps-Jordan
Leon Faulk
Kayla Fowler
Dakeem Hamilton
Samuel Hickson
Marquis Hudson
Devonne Jackson
Kimberly Kennedy
Robert Lancaster
Theara Lanh
Akelah Moore
Jasmine Narcisse
Randi Phillips
Chase Roberts
Anne Tyska
Jannet Walker
Lawrence Williams

San Antonio

Jeffery Arndt
Boris Davis
Samantha Kool
Riti Madugula
Roxanna Smith

Southern California

Frank Alejandro
Rubina Chaudhary
Charles Powell
Reginald Reese
Alicia Walker

St. Louis

Dwain Cosby
Christopher Current

Washington, D.C.

David Do
Kevin Malachi
Jerry Malone

Diversity in Motion

Luther Wynder Promoted to Operations Control System Supervisor



On July 1, 2012, **Luther Wynder, MBA, MSIT**, was promoted to Operations Control Systems Supervisor. With seven years of service, Luther will now oversee the Trapeze, Automated Passenger Counters (APC) and related Operations systems at Delaware Transit Corporation. Mr. Wynder is the Immediate Past President of the COMTO Delaware Chapter. ■

METRO RTA Announces Appointment of COMTO Member to Serve as Executive Director



Summit County METRO RTA's Board of Trustees announced the appointment of **Richard M. Enty** as METRO's Executive Director at its monthly meeting on July 31. Enty joined METRO in 2011 as its Director of Planning. Prior to coming to METRO he worked as a consultant for Lorain County Transit and served on the Cuyahoga Valley Scenic Railroad Board of Trustees for over

16 years. Enty's transit career began in 1977 at Greater Cleveland RTA. "His breadth of experience and knowledge of transportation issues are what garnered him the appointment," stated **Saundra M. Foster**, Board of Trustees President. "His sole interest is to continue to grow METRO and make it the best transit system around." ■

White House Honors Two COMTO Members

On Tuesday, July 31, 2012, the White House honored "Champions of Change" in which **Dr. Beverly Scott**, CEO of MARTA, and **Phil Washington**, CEO of Denver RTD, were among 14 honorees from the transportation industry recognized for "Winning the Future Across America." Beverly was recognized for her long-time and tireless advocacy for public transportation, and Phil was recognized for the innovative "RTD Workforce Initiative Now" program. Please join the COMTO National Board as we salute these two COMTO members for this prestigious National award. Congratulations, Bev and Phil. You make us all very proud. ■



Eno Executive Vice President Announces Departure

August 13, 2012 (Washington, D.C.) – **Dr. Barbara K. Gannon**, Executive Vice President and Executive Director of the Eno Center for Transportation Leadership (CTL), notified the President and Eno Board of Directors that she will leave full-time employment with Eno on October 1, 2012, to return to her leadership consultation practice. Dr. Gannon will continue to be involved in the delivery of numerous Eno courses as a teacher, facilitator, and consultant. Other CTL faculty, including **Paula Kellogg** and **Alyce French Johnson**, will also continue in their existing roles.

Dr. Gannon is well known to the transportation community through her work as Executive Director of the CTL program and through her unparalleled efforts in developing the transportation leaders of the future. "This includes her participation on and leadership in a number of national workforce development projects. Dr. Gannon is also working with the COMTO Leadership to address industry wide succession planning." ■

CITY Interns Celebrate Successful Conference... Welcomed by the COMTO Family

Pulling their suitcases behind them, headed to Denver Airport for the return trip home to Atlanta, Houston, Philadelphia, Baltimore and Washington, DC, the 2012 CITY (Careers In Transportation for Youth) Interns left COMTO's 41st National Meeting and Training Conference exhausted and elated.

For four days, these college juniors and seniors attended informative workshops, networked, exchanged business cards, and got to rub shoulders with the very top echelon of the transportation industry.

Jasmine Narcisse, a CITY Intern working at the Federal Transit Administration (FTA) in Philadelphia, called it "an amazing experience. Being my first conference to attend, I really did not know what to expect. We were told that we would have the opportunity to speak with some high-ranking officials and network with other professionals in the transportation industry – that was, by far, an understatement."

"COMTO is pleased to partner with FTA in preparing the next generation of leaders for our industry,"

Julie Cunningham
President and CEO of COMTO

One of the highlights for Washington, DC Intern **Denzel Golden**, who attends Temple University majoring in Civil Engineering, was getting to sit next to **Peter Rogoff**, who heads the Federal Transit Administration (FTA). Administrator Rogoff gave the keynote for the COMTO Scholarship Luncheon. Afterwards, he and **Phil Washington**, GM/CEO, Denver Regional Transit Division, met in a separate session with the interns, challenging them to pursue a career in the transportation field.

Funded by the FTA, COMTO's CITY Intern Program completed its eighth year. The program is a joint effort between COMTO and FTA to attract the best and brightest young talent of under-represented youth to the public transportation industry.

The 2012 CITY class consists of 17 interns working for 10 weeks this summer with industry stakeholders in five cities: Atlanta, Denver, Houston, Philadelphia and Washington, DC. They hail from 13 different colleges and universities and represent

continued on page 10

Diversity in Motion *(continued from page 9)*

Atlanta intern **Araya Jackson** sums up the experience:

"Thank you so much for letting me into the COMTO family and introducing me to a whole new world of possibilities."

"COMTO has opened so many doors in my life and I am very thankful for that. Once again thank you for the opportunity of my lifetime. "

David Folarin

Former COMTO CITY Intern
Civil Engineer Major
Prairie View A&M University
Prairie View, TX

"I can wholeheartedly say that I left the conference a better woman. I look forward to continuing this relationship through the alumni opportunity as well as COMTO as a whole."

Tolulope Olusada

CITY Intern
Communications Major
Villanova University | Villanova, PA

an array of majors, including: accounting, business, communications, engineering, economics, geography, law, marketing, international business, Japanese studies, psychology, sociology and supply chain management. All of these careers can be found in the transportation industry.

COMTO received 78 applications for the program's 15 internship positions. The high caliber of applicants led local COMTO Chapters in Colorado and Washington, DC to each fund an additional intern position, bringing the total number of interns to 17. The interns were selected based on program requirements and proximity to the five local COMTO Chapter locations.

Indeed, the theme for COMTO's National Conference, *Investing in the Workforce/Rebuilding the Nation*, is a perfect fit with the CITY Internship Program.

Expressing the sentiments of the whole COMTO family, **Charles Cave**, COMTO's liaison and mentor for the Houston CITY interns, described the conference as "exciting, informative, and powerful. This was truly one of those life changing kind of events." ■

COMTO Chapter Presidents (Active Chapters)

Atlanta

Joseph Erves
Metropolitan Atlanta Rapid Transit Authority
jjerves@itsmarta.com

Austin

Dinita Caldwell
Capital Metro Transit Authority
Dinita.caldwell@capmetro.org

Birmingham

Michael H. Bell
Birmingham Construction Industry Authority
bcia1@bellsouth.net

Boston

Roma McKenzie-Campbell
MBTA
romamac1960@yahoo.com

Central Florida

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COMTO USA

COMTO Delaware

National Visit to Delaware Chapter

On Wednesday, August 8, 2012, **Julie Cunningham**, COMTO President/CEO; **Warren Montague**, COMTO Board First Vice Chair; and COMTO Delaware Officers **Semia Hackett** (President) and **Luther Wynder** (Immediate Past President) met with Delaware's Department of Transportation (DelDOT) Secretary **Shailen Bhatt** and Delaware Transit Corporation's (DTC) Executive Director **Lauren Skiver**.

After meeting with Secretary Bhatt and Lauren Skiver, Julie and Warren attended COMTO Delaware's monthly membership meeting. ■

Delaware Chapter Partners with Delaware Transit Corporation to Host "Eyes in Transit" Youth Day

On Friday, July 27, 2012, COMTO Delaware partnered with Delaware Transit Corporation to host an "Eyes on Transit" Youth Day for the Delaware State University's National Summer Transportation Institute (NSTI). The NSTI, a federally funded four-week program, offers rising high school juniors and seniors the opportunity to become stimulated and aware of the different career opportunities within the transportation industry.

Fifteen students were selected from various schools statewide to participate in the program. The students were given the opportunity to visit a variety of transportation properties.

Tremica Cherry, 2nd Vice-President, collaborated with fellow COMTO members and co-workers from different departments to present DART public transit services. DTC Staff presented an overview of the vast career opportunities in Human Resources, Marketing, Finance, Planning, Technology, Operations, Maintenance and Safety.

COMTO members **Semia Hackett**, Chapter President **Corey Burris**, 1st Vice-President **Luther Wynder**, **Beverly Barr-Ford**, and **Aldrich Hines** presented during the student's visit and were instrumental in making the program a success. ■

COMTO Maryland

COMTO Maryland Honors Past Presidents

COMTO Maryland hosted a tribute to past COMTO Maryland Presidents. Maryland is proud of its rich legacy and history and grateful to the many people who have paved the way to make this Chapter rich. The event was well attended and each President spoke about what it means to be a COMTO member. "It was important to celebrate our past leaders who still serve as consultants for the Chapter," says **Adrienne Barnes**, President of COMTO Maryland. "Maryland is highly respected and appreciated because of the work created by our leaders." Past Presidents honored included **Ken Chapman**, **Beverly Hill**, **Helen Dale**, **Minnie Carter**, **Greg Brown** and **Keith Scroggins**. Secretary of the Maryland Department of Transportation **Beverly K. Swaim-Staley**, **Darrell Mobley** and **Paul J. Wiedefeld**, Executive Director, MAA, were among the many guests who attended the event.



Ken Chapman, Beverly Hill, Helen Dale, Secretary of MDOT, Beverly Swaim-Staley, Greg Brown, Keith Scroggins and Adrienne Barnes



Board Members Richard Hooper, Marisol Peralta, Treasurer Tina Dorn, Board Member Mike Rice, 2nd Vice President Meshelle Howard, President Adrienne Barnes, Secretary Kimberly James and National Board Member Brad Mims

COMTO San Antonio

COMTO San Antonio Sponsored Lunch for the Aviation Career and Education Academy

On Tuesday, July 17, COMTO San Antonio sponsored a lunch for the Aviation Career and Education Academy (ACE). The ACE Academy is a nationally recognized program hosted annually by the Organization of Black Aerospace Professionals and co-sponsored by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and the National Black Coalition of Aviation Employees (NBCFAE). The purpose of ACE is to offer first level exposure to the aviation industry by offering aviation career exploration for middle and high school students.

COMTO San Antonio was represented by members **Wanda Scott**, Bus Operator (VIA Metropolitan Transit) and **Pamela Sattiewhite**, Flight Attendant (American Airlines). ■

Please join us for the 20th Annual CBCF/COMTO Transportation Braintrust.

The New Surface Transportation Bill: Moving Ahead for Progress in the 21st Century (MAP-21)

The Impact on Historically Underutilized Businesses

Thursday, September 20, 2012 | 1:30 pm – 3:30 pm

Walter E. Washington Convention Center | Washington, DC | Room 144 A



OFFICIAL HOST

The Honorable Elijah Cummings
U.S. Congress
Maryland's 7th District



MODERATOR

Roland Martin
Host
Washington Watch with Roland Martin

PANELISTS:

Robert Ashby
Author of recent *DBE Final Rulemaking*
Former Employee
USDOT/OST

William Clyburn, Jr
President/CEO
Clyburn Consulting LLC

Tony Thompson
President/CEO
Kwame Building Group

Cheron Wicker
Deputy Director of
Public Engagement
Office of the Secretary
U.S. Department of
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Washington, DC

Board Advisors

*To be appointed by the newly elected
Board of Directors.*



Accelerate is a quarterly newsletter published by the
Conference Of Minority Transportation Officials (COMTO)
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Publisher: Julie A. Cunningham

Editor: Bill Carney

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COMTO Vision Statement

To see the diverse faces of America equally reflected in all
levels of the transportation industry.

COMTO Mission Statement

To ensure a level playing field and maximum participation in the
transportation industry for minority individuals, businesses, and
communities of color through advocacy, information sharing,
training, educational, and professional development.

COMTO Core Values

COMTO's core values are embodied in how we conduct business
and how we interact with our stakeholders, including our members,
customers, partners, and supporters. We affirm and are committed
to the following core values: Advocacy, Diversity, Excellence,
Inclusion, Innovation, Integrity, and Service.



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